

KEEP THE PROOF — VERSION 2

Stage 2 correction pack

Prepared for Temidayo Afonja, The Density Group. September 18, 2026.

This pack accompanies the corrected manuscript and Professional Record. It records exactly what changed in response to the Stage 2 editorial and product QA pass, updates the legal-review placeholder list, audits manuscript-to-record consistency, lists what still needs your decision before design, and confirms that no unresolved research hypothesis was converted into a settled claim. No final production PDF was generated. The live website and Starter page were not touched. No LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED placeholder was removed.

I. Correction log

Correction 1. Overbroad talent–decision claim, removed. – Welcome, middle paragraphs: rewritten. The claim that Temidayo spent eighteen years "close to where talent decisions get made," and that people fared well because they could describe their work, is gone. The new version establishes the warrant ("worked in and around talent, workforce, and organizational decisions") and states plainly that articulation does not decide who is promoted, hired, or selected; sponsorship, opportunity, timing, and conditions do. What a record affects is narrower: how clearly the work can be understood when a decision depends on it. – About the author: the parallel line ("For eighteen years... close to where talent decisions get made") was softened to "Over nearly two decades... worked in and around workforce strategy, organizational design, and talent decisions," so no claim is made that every year was spent close to talent decisions.

Correction 2. Incomplete first–session sentence, fixed. – Your First 60 Minutes (capture route): "Before you name one person..." became "Before you finish, name one person who could confirm the work, by role, and note what they directly observed." Corroboration stays narrow.

Correction 3. Cadence, returned to test–before–changing. – Part Eight, "Keeping it current": rewritten. The claim that tying capture to events is "the lightest way" and "matches how work actually arrives" is gone. The section now presents two useful approaches, event–based capture and a periodic sweep, states that neither is universally better, and tells the reader to use whichever they will sustain, or both. Event triggers remain prominent; the monthly and quarterly routines remain available. – Operating summary: the rhythm line was reworded to present both cadences without privileging either. – First-session trigger bullet: "an event rather than only a date" became "an upcoming event or a recurring date both work." – Professional Record, Section 6, and the review pack's change log and discipline note were updated to match.

Correction 4. AI prompt, narrowed to the approved boundary. – Part Eight, the optional AI prompt: the requests for "a short resume line, a spoken interview version, and a one-line summary" were removed. The prompt now helps only with removing jargon, producing plain portable language, preserving scope, separating team result from individual contribution, refining a single Proof Line, and flagging vague, inflated, or unsupported wording. A new line forbids it from writing a resume, an interview answer, a profile, or anything tailored to a specific job or employer. The confidentiality guardrail and the "never invent facts, numbers, or results" instruction are unchanged.

Correction 5. Employer-verification claim, bounded. – Part Four, "Who could confirm this": "Employers will usually confirm only your title and your dates" became "Formal employment verification is often limited to basic details such as your title and your dates, while the people who worked closely with you may remember far more of the contribution itself." The bounded language on what corroboration can and cannot do (strengthen credibility, not decide an employer's choice) is retained.

Correction 6. Legal language, kept legal-gated. – Part One, "The boundary": a caveat was added stating that the account-versus-artifact distinction is a practical habit, not a legal ruling, and that ownership can be genuinely unsettled in some situations (contract work, work made for hire, signed terms), which are legal questions where the one rule governs. A new LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED note was added to that page. – "Documents you already lawfully hold" was changed to "Documents you already hold" on both the lawful-channels page and the reconstruction sources page, so the phrasing does not state a legal conclusion; the LEGAL REVIEW notes continue to govern. – A manuscript-wide scan for definitive legal-sounding statements outside gated blocks was run. Findings and their handling are in the legal list (Section 2). No LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED placeholder was removed or finalized.

Correction 7. "Proof" not overstated. – The claim-example-evidence-corroboration hierarchy is unchanged and remains the reference. Surrounding copy was adjusted so it does not treat every account as documentary proof: "complete evidence of judgment" became "a complete account of the judgment," and "vague improvement is not evidence. Specific improvement is." became "vague improvement does not persuade. Specific improvement does." The product name is unchanged. This was a copy-discipline pass, not a rename.

Correction 8. Recognition-led editorial pass. – The manuscript was read for the recognition-before-education standard. It already opens with recognition and keeps explanations short after a distinction is made, and the completed examples carry much of the teaching. The Welcome and cadence rewrites also tightened prose. Findings: the manuscript does not read as a textbook; the few repeated statements of what the system does sit at deliberate summary points (the Carry seam, the edge-of-the-tool page, and the operating summary) and were kept on purpose. No depth was cut to make the product feel thinner.

Correction 9. Whole-read experience test. Results in Section 4.

Correction 10. Professional Record consistency. Audit in Section 3. One change made: the Professional Record's maintenance section was reworded to match the corrected, neutral cadence framing. All fields otherwise match the corrected manuscript.

Correction 11. Free-to-paid and ladder boundaries. Preserved and unchanged. The Starter finishes one accomplishment and one result; Keep the Proof establishes the broader record the reader keeps building; the Field Kit and Career Move Review own destination-specific interpretation. Nothing in this pass weakened the Starter or expanded Keep the Proof into the Field Kit.

2. Updated legal-review placeholder list

The complete set of legal gates after this pass. None was removed; one was added (L6). No wording was finalized.

- L1. Not-legal-advice statement and confidentiality note (front matter). Carried from Version 1, held for confirmation.
- L2. Lawful ways to rebuild the record (Part Three). Personnel-record rights, documents the employee may treat as their own, written permission, and use of public work. Named as intent only; all specifics withheld.
- L3. Anonymized process accounts (cross-cutting). Standard kept strict pending counsel; no change made.
- L4. Corroboration and privacy (Part Four; Professional Record Section 3). Role and observation only, no personal contact detail; flagged for confirmation.
- L5. Reconstruction sources near employer-owned information (Part Seven). Listed with a governing note; boundaries withheld and cross-referenced to L2.
- L6. Account-versus-artifact ownership caveat (Part One). NEW in this pass. The practical distinction is taught; ownership questions (work made for hire, contractor versus employee, signed agreements) are flagged as legal, with a marked note and no legal conclusion.

Also carried for review, not yet written into reader-facing pages because they do not change Version 2 instructions: work-for-hire and portfolio use; contractor versus employee ownership; client confidentiality layered on employer confidentiality; severance and non-disparagement clauses; preservation exceptions; and employer AI-tool and monitoring policies.

Result of the manuscript-wide legal scan (Correction 6): the phrases the QA pass named, the account being yours to keep, documents already held, public artifacts, personnel-record access, written permission, employer-owned artifacts, colleague observations, AI use, and post-employment reconstruction, are each either taught as a practical habit with an added caveat (the boundary page), or already sit under a LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED note (the lawful-channels page, the reconstruction sources page, the corroboration page). No definitive legal conclusion is stated outside a gated block.

3. Consistency audit: manuscript versus Professional Record

Field by field, after the corrections. Match means the two documents agree.

- Quick Capture, five prompts (what happened; specific contribution or judgment; what changed, improved, became possible, or was prevented; verifier role or permitted public reference; confidential detail to keep out): MATCH.
- Full Entry clusters (when and what; what was actually yours; the judgment inside it; what changed and what supports it; how you would say it and who could confirm it): MATCH.
- Judgment and decision fields (decision or judgment exercised; actions taken): MATCH.
- Prevention field (problem prevented, with "would likely have" honesty): MATCH.
- Team result versus individual contribution field: MATCH.
- Corroboration (who could confirm this, by role, and what they directly observed; role and observation only, no personal contact detail): MATCH.
- Permission and confidentiality check field: MATCH.
- Retrieval tags (review, promotion, compensation, resume, interview, biography, transition): MATCH.
- Proof Line ingredients (condition, your part, scope or constraint, outcome, support): MATCH.
- Reconstruction certainty labels (Known; Supported; Remembered but not verified; Uncertain): MATCH.
- Maintenance cadence framing: MATCH after correction (both documents now present event capture and a periodic sweep neutrally).
- No field asks the reader to store anything the handbook tells them not to store: CONFIRMED. Every field is an account, a role, or a tag; none invites an employer-owned artifact, a personal contact record, or confidential detail.

No conflicts were found that required a silent choice. The one difference (cadence framing) was reconciled by editing the Professional Record to match the corrected manuscript, and is logged here rather than resolved silently.

4. Whole-read experience test (Correction 9)

The corrected manuscript read straight through as a paying customer.

1. Does the reader do something early enough? Yes. The two doors and Your First 60 Minutes put the reader into capture within the first several pages, and the event triggers lower the cost of starting.
2. Does the first session feel achievable, not like another assignment? Yes. It is a timed checklist with a visible finish line and seven concrete outcomes, and it explicitly is not a whole-product completion promise.
3. Is Capture, Clarify, Carry obvious throughout? Yes. It is the spine page, the part structure, and the operating summary.

4. Does Clarify still feel like the differentiated center? Yes. It is the largest teaching part and holds team-versus-part, judgment, prevention, scope-without-title, and corroboration.
 5. Does permission or legal content break momentum? The full permission standard sits in Part Three, after the reader has already captured in the first session and Part Two, and its opening line cross-references the rule the reader already met. The placement reads as a natural deepening rather than an interruption. Exact sequencing of permission remains a test (see Section 5); no permission content was weakened to improve flow.
 6. Do worked examples carry enough teaching that prose can be shorter? Yes. The examples do a large share of the teaching, and surrounding prose is kept short after each distinction is made.
 7. Does it feel built for experienced professionals, including senior non-technical work? Yes. Scope without title, judgment under uncertainty, prevention, people development, coordination, and relationship repair are all represented in ordinary language before any label.
 8. Does reconstruction feel like an equal entrance, not a failure path? Yes. It is one of two equally weighted doors, has its own first-session route, and its tone is explicitly non-penalty.
 9. Does the Professional Record feel like the actual thing the customer is building? Yes. The handbook points at it throughout, and Part Nine names it as the long-term home.
 10. Does the manuscript stay outside resume writing, interview coaching, stay-or-leave diagnosis, destination-specific decisions, and promises about employer or market outcomes? Yes, and the AI-prompt narrowing in this pass closes the one place that had drifted toward application outputs.
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5. Still requires your decision before design

1. Permission sequencing. The full standard sits in Part Three, after Capture. This reads well, but exact placement and how much appears before the first tool remains a test. Confirm the current sequence, or ask for a different one, before design.
2. Cadence framing. Both approaches are now presented neutrally, per this pass. Confirm that neutral framing is what you want carried into design, since cadence remains unresolved by research.
3. Routine labels. The Monthly and Quarterly routines are described plainly in the manuscript. Whether to keep, rename, or drop the proprietary labels (Monthly Proof Sweep, Quarterly Proof Review, Quarterly Evidence Index) is still a test. Please decide before design if you want the labels changed.
4. Quick Capture terminology. The Quick Capture keeps the Version 1 field name "verifier role or permitted public reference," while the rest of the product uses "who could confirm this." They mean the same thing. Decide whether to align the Quick Capture wording to "who could confirm this" for consistency, or keep the familiar field name.

5. Worked-example set. Version 2 adds four new examples (judgment under uncertainty, people development, relationship repair, and the returner) plus the scope-without-title example inside Clarify. This covers all five approved territories with the fewest examples that teach the distinctions. Confirm the set, or ask to trim or adjust any.
 6. Legal review. Commission counsel on L1 through L6. This remains a production gate; the affected pages cannot be finalized without it.
 7. Page-count range. The 44 to 56 range stands as a ceiling. Confirm, or set a different target, before design.
 8. Reconstruction separability note. Part Seven includes a short note that the material is built so it could be lifted into a dedicated path later. Confirm you want that note kept in the reader-facing text, or moved to internal notes only.
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6. Research-discipline confirmation

Confirmed: no item that Research Pass 2 marked TEST BEFORE CHANGING, unknown, unresolved, or candidate has been silently converted into a settled claim, and this pass strengthened that discipline.

- Cadence: the one place that had drifted into a settled claim ("the lightest way... matches how work actually arrives") was corrected in this pass. Both cadences are now presented as options, neither asserted as better.
 - Permission sequencing: presented as the current design and flagged as still a test; the standard itself is unchanged and load-bearing.
 - Visibility outputs: still excluded; the AI prompt that had reached toward resume and interview outputs was narrowed back.
 - Price, name, reconstruction placement: resolved by the approval brief and unchanged.
 - The word "proof": name unchanged; the copy-discipline pass keeps the hierarchy precise without a rename.
 - Maintenance and abandonment: not asserted in either direction.
 - All legal items: withheld to counsel; one added, none removed or finalized.
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END OF STAGE 2 CORRECTION PACK